had been laid by his Ghaznavid precursors.[10] Much of the Shansabani activity in the same areas, along with their own imperial marks, are fruitfully conceived, then, as *re-inscriptions* of already existing socio-political assets within their own jurisdiction, for example, by means of substantial endowments (Ar.-Pers. *waqf*) to pre-existing architectural complexes and the institutions they housed. The larger territorial acquisitions were delegated to allied military leaders and their dependents.[11]

Chapter 2 explored the pre-imperial Shansabanis' extensive adaptation and reuse of the landscapes they inherited throughout historical Ghur. Given the early Shansabanis' greater transhumance and/or nomadism during the eleventh and early twelfth centuries, new construction of purpose-built, monumental architecture was neither needed nor possible – the latter due to the lack of sufficient surplus means to patronize laborers skilled in building traditions beyond the nomad–urban continuum. Things did, of course, shift considerably during the intervening three-quarters of a century or so, both in lifestyle as well as economy: by the early decades of the 1100s, it is probable that the Shansabanis were politico-economically surpassing other Ghuris, and their upward trajectory necessitated increasingly monumental architectural patronage. If the *minar* of Da Qadi has been correctly identified as that of Qal'a-yi Zarmurgh and accurately dated to the first quarter of the twelfth century (Chapter 2), we could surmise that, by this time, the Shansabanis had access to builders with some familiarity with Persianate traditions, and their ability to implement these on a localized level. Indeed, by the 1170s, large-scale construction had been undertaken by the Shansabani lineages at Firuzkuh and Bamiyan, and to a somewhat lesser extent by the newly crowned Sultan Mu'izz al-Din at ex-Ghaznavid sites, all of which surpassed the scale and quality of their own earlier efforts and placed them firmly within the courtly trends of the larger cosmopolitan Persianate world (cf. Chapters 3–5).

It is in fact Mu'izz al-Din and the Ghazna Shansabanis who stand out as we explore farther eastward. Not only were they the protagonists of these successful campaigns ever deeper into the Indic cultural world, they had also distinguished their particular mode of building empire as one primarily based on the re-inscription of pre-existing environments rather than the creation of new ones, as amply evidenced at Ghazna and Lashkari Bazar, and probably also Bust (see Chapter 5). As further demonstrated by the Shansabanis of Bamiyan also, those pre-imperial tendencies toward adaptation of inherited built forms and landscapes were not entirely superseded by the patronage of new buildings. But in the Indus-dependent areas and beyond, rather than only *physical* reuse or repurposing of inherited structures, *all* remnants of past empires and their attendant societal assets – particularly those of the Yamini–Ghaznavids – were meaningfully re-inscribed, layered with a Shansabani mark in addition to that of their immediate predecessors.